Zain Dana Harper

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AI Evaluation | Security Evaluation | Python Developer Tools

Summary

Self-directed builder moving from arboriculture into AI and security evaluation. Flagship projects share one aim: make checking cheap, protect the commons, and keep provenance at the source.

Technical Skills

Python, Rust, C++, Dart/Flutter, SQL, GitHub Actions, pytest, Linux, Windows; AI evaluation, planted-fault and control design, red-team and purple-team test cases, MCP, APIs, deterministic testing, offline verification.

Self-Directed Projects

About 13 years self-directed | Career transition began June 2026

- Shipped Flywheel 1.9.0 on PyPI, a Python/Flutter AI workstation with model routing and a Windows installer; its behavior-check caught 20 of 20 planted changes with 0 of 50 false alarms.
- Built 324 exhaustive terminal-state fixtures and 337 component cases with 5,058 frozen expectations, separating failed outputs from valid results.
- Built Articulate 0.15.0 writing analysis, Accountable Surface approval interfaces, BuildLang 1.8.0 capability checks, and Phantom audit/restore workflows for inspectable changes.
- Built Daylight Commons 3.1.0, AGPL, nine platforms; slur-sign precision 3,995 of 4,392 on labelled corpora.
- Ran a pinned METR count_odds check with three deterministic controls, keeping logs and score provenance through the Inspect-to-Flywheel handoff.
- Maintained Elder ENB, a Skyrim lighting preset: 996,649 downloads and 2,413 endorsements on Nexus Mods.

Freelance Technical Writer | Independent projects | Began 2017

- Wrote implementation guides, API documentation, and release notes for developers and customers.

Employment

Arboriculture and Field Operations | Legendary Tree

Seattle area | April 25, 2015 to June 2, 2026

- Turned site assessments into estimates, proposals, and workable job scopes; coordinated clients, crews, and vendors so teams understood access constraints, timing, and hazards.

Technical Networking Support | Stream/Convergys | 2014 to 2015

Xbox/Microsoft product contract | Wilsonville, Oregon

- Resolved Xbox connectivity problems across TCP/IP, DNS, NAT, firewalls, and routers; documented troubleshooting steps for consistent support handoffs.

Open-Source Contributions: 37 Merged in 30 Repositories

- DeepEval #2822: fixed crashes on unhashable tool outputs and nested parameters, with regression tests. Merged.
- TOMLKit #549: preserved sibling keys in dotted-key replacement, preventing silent configuration loss. Merged.
- Datasette #2815: corrected malformed composite-key requests from HTTP 500 to HTTP 400, with tests. Merged.

Credentials, Training, and Education

Qualys Certified Specialist: six certifications, including VMDR, EDR and Policy Audit. Microsoft Applied Skills: four security credentials (95% assessment). Cisco Ethical Hacker. Full record: harperz9.github.io/cv.html.

High School Diploma | Wilsonville High School, Oregon | 2013